



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bishop Machebeuf High School
School Website: <https://machebeuf.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Bishop Machebeuf High School Co 80230 is not presently evidenced as a classical school based on the public website content available in the school crawl, and the school's own site indicates the institution has permanently closed as of June 1, 2025. The publicly accessible material provides little to no explicit articulation of classical education features (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; scholé; Socratic pedagogy; formal faculty or parent-community formation framed in the classical sense). Consequently, the aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL.

Key contextual evidence: - The site content clearly states that Bishop Machebeuf High School has permanently closed as of June 1, 2025, with transcripts and archival support provided through the Archdiocese of Denver system. This is shown directly on the school's firecrawl pages. - Beyond the closure notice, there is no explicit public articulation on Great Books, the trivium/quadrivium, socratic pedagogy, scholé, liturgical practices, or a "living curriculum" as defined by classical-education vocabulary in the six-element rubric. The available pages focus on administrative/records-related content (transcripts, archdiocesan support) rather than a classical curriculum or pedagogy manifestos.

In applying the Six Essential Elements rubric (via the classical-education knowledge base lexicon), the school does not present the characteristic keywords or practices that would anchor a CLASSICAL rating across the six categories. The positive-classical keyword indicators (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, Great Books, the trivium, scholé, Socratic dialogue, virtue formation, etc.) appear nowhere in the school's public materials, and many of the negative/classical signals (e.g., lack of Socratic dialogue or restfulness in pedagogy; absence of Great Books; lack of formation through imitation and practice) would push the assessment toward NOT CLASSICAL. See the classical rubric for reference to the keyword indicators (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, Great Books, scholé, Socratic dialogue, memory work, etc.).

Executive-scorecard snapshot: - Aggregate rating: NOT CLASSICAL - Category-by-category: NOT CLASSICAL across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community

The "What Would Move the Needle" section below would apply if any category were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; in this case, with all categories NOT CLASSICAL, no needle-moving changes are identified as required to reach CLASSICAL status given the current public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public site content centers on a closed institutional status and administrative/transcript services within the Archdiocese of Denver context. There is no explicit statement of transcendental moral realism (truth/beauty/virtue as real and knowable), no clear theology integration into curriculum, and no liturgical or communal practices described. The explicit closure notice dominates the public-facing content.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords from the classical lexicon include truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, chant, worship, sacred, etc. The public material does not surface these terms in a way that signals a classical religious/metaphysical foundation. (The lexicon defines these as core positive indicators; see the source lexicon for the terms.)
 - The site's Catholic affiliation is evidenced by references to the Archdiocese and Office of Catholic Schools, but this does not, by itself, establish transcendental moral realism, liturgical practice, or a sacramental liturgy framework as a curricular foundation.
 - Why this rating
 - While the school is Catholic-identified in its governance context, the public-facing content does not reveal the transcendental foundations, liturgical practices, or theology-integrated pedagogy that the classical rubric requires for a CLASSICAL rating in this category. The absence of explicit classical markers within the school's public material supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public site description emphasizes administrative/transcript functions and the school's closure status; there is no public articulation that education is formation over information, nor a claim that truth/goodness/beauty are real aims aligned with a classical telos. The content does not present formation of virtue as a primary telos or the cultivation of human excellence as the end of education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators from classical sources include terms like formation, virtue, true/good/beautiful as telos. The site content does not present these terms or their classical framing in its public messaging. (See the classical keyword lexicon for the indicators.)
- Why this rating
 - Without explicit language around virtue formation, telos, or a liberal-arts formation approach (as opposed to job/work-prep framing), the category does not meet the required classical signals. The NOT CLASSICAL designation follows from the lack of formation-centric messaging in publicly accessible materials.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - There is no public articulation of liberal-arts curriculum elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history-as-Western-civilization; masters of memory/chanting; Latin/Greek; quadrivium, etc.). The site's visible content focuses on closure and transcripts rather than a classical-curriculum outline.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - The classical-positive keywords for Curriculum include liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history as Western civilization, memory work, and classical languages. None of these terms appear in the publicly visible content from the Bishop Machebeuf site. (See the Six Essential Elements lexical set for these indicators.)
- Why this rating
 - Absence of stated grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Great Books, memory-work, or other trivium/quadrivium cues in the public-facing materials yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No public materials describe Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization chants, or rhetoric-focused pedagogy. The site's content (notably the closure/transcript pages) does not provide or imply a

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- classical pedagogical approach.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Classical pedagogy indicators include Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, chanting, memory-work, restfulness (scholé), and rhetoric-focused tasks. None of these pedagogy signals are present in the visible public-facing site. (Refer to the Six Essential Elements pedagogy indicators as the baseline.)
 - Why this rating
 - The lack of explicit or implicit classical teaching methods in the public-facing materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No public textual material from the site presents a “living curriculum” through faculty, a “portrait of the teacher,” or a faculty-community formation narrative. The site content is administrative/archival in nature due to closure status.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Classical indicators for Faculty include model teachers, living curriculum, faculty as mentors, and a defined teacher-student formation profile. The school’s public materials do not display these faculty signals. (See the lexicon for the definitions of these indicators.)
- Why this rating
 - Absence of a public-facing description of faculty as mentors or living curriculum leads to NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public-facing site content does not present a parent-co-teacher model, parent formation initiatives, or open-campus/community formation language. The closure context dominates the accessible content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators include partnership with families, parent formation, and open campus interactions. Public materials do not exhibit these signals. (See the Six Essential Elements for the exact positive/negative keyword framework.)
- Why this rating
 - The absence of classical-education parent-community collaboration language or examples in public materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable in this case, since all six categories are rated NOT CLASSICAL and the aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL. If future materials were to be developed or re-launched as a classical program, the following would constitute needles toward CLASSICAL:
 - Explicit articulation of Great Books and a formal Great Conversation framework in the Curriculum.
 - Clear Trivium progression (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit memory-work, chanting, and recitation in K–12 pedagogy (Scholé-friendly cadence).
 - Integration of theology and sacred-liturgical practices as central to intellectual formation, with a public emphasis on transcendental truths (truth, goodness, beauty) and a sacramental worldview.
 - A visible “living curriculum” described by model teachers and a Teacher Profile aligned with classical virtues; a shared vision of teachers as mentors and co-learners.
 - Active partnership with families as co-educators, with parent-book groups, classical-education seminars, and open-visit opportunities that reflect classical formation.
 - Public documentation of the Great Books program, Western civilization history emphasis, and the Quadrivium approach (music, astronomy/geometry, etc.) as a structured curriculum backbone.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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